HARE KRISHNA GOLDEN TEMPLE
BANJARA HILLS

PUNYA KSHETRAS
NOURISH YOUR SOUL ON SACRED JOURNEYS

PREMIUM PILGRIMAGE · MARCH 2027

# Vaishno Devi
## & Kashmir Pilgrimage

with ISKCON Hare Krishna Devotees







**13 – 20 March 2027**

**7 Nights / 8 Days**

Jammu · Katra · Vaishno Devi · Srinagar · Gulmarg · Sonamarg · Pahalgam

Helicopter darshan | Night at Bhawan | Flight to Srinagar | Gulmarg · Sonamarg · Pahalgam | Sattvic food

Book Now →

95053 88886

www.punyakshetras.com
www.hkmhyderabad.org

# Warm greetings *from Punya Kshetras*

Begin with the temples of Jammu and Mother Vaishno Devi's darshan by helicopter, with a night at Bhawan for both Aartis. Then fly into the Kashmir valley, the land of Kheer Bhawani, Shankaracharya and Martand, where Gulmarg's snow, Sonamarg's glaciers and Pahalgam's valleys complete a pilgrimage that is as devotional as it is beautiful, in the association of ISKCON Hare Krishna devotees.

Punya Kshetras is the pilgrimage service of Hare Krishna Golden Temple, Banjara Hills, Hyderabad. Every yatra is led by devotees, with kirtan, japa and the glories of each holy place narrated along the way, sattvic food, careful planning and special attention to elders.



His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Srila Prabhupada,
Founder-Acharya of ISKCON

> *The holy places all over the earth are meant for purifying the polluted consciousness of the human being by an atmosphere surcharged with the presence of the Lord's unalloyed devotees. If anyone visits a holy place, he must search out the pure devotees residing in such holy places, take lessons from them, try to apply such instructions in practical life and thus gradually prepare oneself for moksha.*
>
> Srila Prabhupada · Srimad Bhagavatam 1.13.10, Purport

## YATRA HIGHLIGHTS

- ★ Jammu temple circuit
- ★ Helicopter darshan of Shri Mata Vaishno Devi
- ★ Night at Bhawan with Evening & Morning Aarti
- ★ Bhairon Baba Temple by ropeway
- ★ Banganga & Darshani Deodi
- ★ Shikara ride on Dal Lake
- ★ Maharani Temple and gondola, Gulmarg
- ★ Kheer Bhawani Temple, Tulmulla
- ★ Martand Sun Temple & Avantipur ruins
- ★ Shankaracharya & Jyeshta Devi temples
- ★ Gulmarg, Sonamarg & Pahalgam excursions
- ★ Amalaki Ekadashi observed together on 17 March

## OVERNIGHT STAYS

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 Night JAMMU | 1 Night BHAWAN | 1 Night KATRA |
| 2 Nights SRINAGAR | 1 Night GULMARG | 1 Night PAHALGAM |

## YOUR DEPARTURE

Mid-March brings pleasant weather in Jammu and late-winter snow in Kashmir: carry warm layers for Gulmarg, Sonamarg and Pahalgam, where nights are near freezing.

# The route *step by step*

| 8 | 7 | 2 | 641 | 15 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| DAYS | NIGHTS | HELICOPTER RIDES | KM BY ROAD | TEMPLES & SHRINES |

**1 Jammu**
Arrival · temple circuit

CAR 50 km

**2 Katra**
RFID · helipad

HELICOPTER 5–8 min

**3 Bhawan**
Darshan · Aarti · night

ROPEWAY 3 min

**4 Bhairon**
Completes the yatra

HELICOPTER 5–8 min

**5 Katra**
Banganga · night stay

CAR + FLIGHT 50 km · 50 min

**6 Srinagar**
Dal Lake shikara

continues → **Car** 52 km

**7 Gulmarg**
Gondola · Maharani Temple

CAR 130 km

**8 Kheer Bhawani**
Sonamarg excursion

CAR 82 km

**9 Srinagar**
Night stay

CAR 105 km

**10 Pahalgam**
Martand · Avantipur · valleys

CAR 95 km

**11 Srinagar**
Shankaracharya · Jyeshta Devi · departure

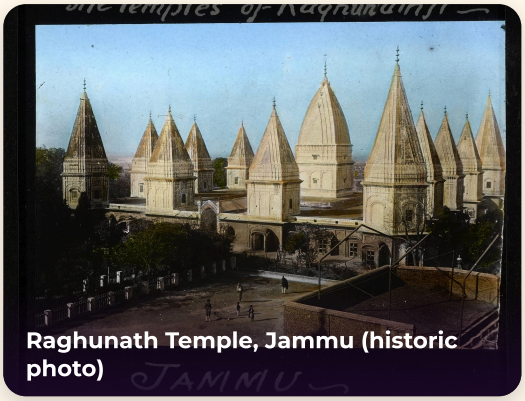

Helicopter to Sanjichhat


Gulmarg Gondola


Betaab Valley, Pahalgam



Bahu Fort, Jammu



Raghunath Temple, Jammu (historic photo)

**DAY 01**
Sat 13 Mar

# Jammu Arrival – Temple Circuit

Overnight: **Jammu**

Arrive at Jammu, the City of Temples, by 2 pm. After check-in and a late lunch at the hotel, begin an evening circuit of its most revered shrines: Sri Raghunath Temple, Ranbireshwar Temple, the Mahakali shrine of Bawe Wali Mata inside Bahu Fort, and the Peer Kho cave temple on the banks of the Tawi, ending with its evening aarti.

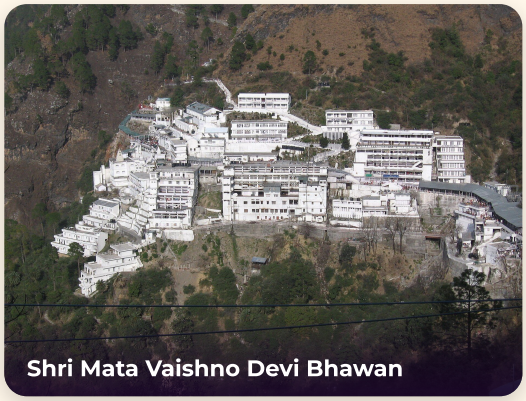
### DID YOU KNOW?

Raghunath Temple, begun by Maharaja Gulab Singh in 1835 and completed by Maharaja Ranbir Singh in 1860, is dedicated to Lord Rama and houses a large collection of saligrama shilas. Ranbireshwar Temple is known for its tall Shiva lingam and twelve crystal lingams.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 08:00 – 08:30 | BREAKFAST | **On own – at home / origin airport / in flight** · Breakfast on own before or during travel to Jammu (not included); carry a light snack, lunch is at 15:15 | |
| 14:00 – 14:30 | ARRIVAL | **Jammu Airport (IXJ) / Jammu Tawi Rly Stn** · Meet representative, garland welcome, load luggage, headcount | |
| 14:30 – 14:50 | CAR | **Jammu Airport → Hotel, Jammu (Residency Rd area)** · Transfer to hotel (from Jammu Tawi station: ~4 km, 15 min) | 7 km |
| 14:50 – 15:15 | HALT | **Hotel, Jammu** · Check-in, freshen up | |
| 15:15 – 15:50 | LUNCH | **Hotel restaurant, Jammu** · Late lunch – at the hotel, pre-ordered pure-veg thali served on arrival; group pays | |
| 15:50 – 16:05 | CAR | **Hotel, Jammu → Raghunath Temple** · Drive to old-city temple complex | 5 km |
| 16:05 – 16:45 | DARSHAN | **Raghunath Temple** · Darshan of Sri Rama, Sita and Lakshmana; galleries of saligramas; group kirtan | |
| 16:45 – 16:55 | CAR | **Raghunath Temple → Ranbireshwar Temple** · Short hop (can also walk ~10 min) | 1 km |
| 16:55 – 17:20 | DARSHAN | **Ranbireshwar Temple** · Darshan of the 7.5 ft Shiva lingam and crystal lingams | |
| 17:20 – 17:40 | CAR | **Ranbireshwar Temple → Bahu Fort (Bawe Wali Mata)** · Cross the Tawi to Bahu Fort | 6 km |
| 17:40 – 18:30 | DARSHAN | **Bawe Wali Mata Temple & Bahu Fort** · Darshan of Mahakali (Bawe Wali Mata); fort ramparts and Bagh-e-Bahu gardens at sunset | |
| 18:30 – 18:55 | CAR | **Bahu Fort → Peer Kho Cave Temple** · Drive along Circular Road | 7 km |
| 18:55 – 19:30 | DARSHAN | **Peer Kho Cave Temple** · Cave shrine of the self-manifest Shiva lingam (Jambavan cave); evening aarti | |
| 19:30 – 19:50 | CAR | **Peer Kho Cave Temple → Hotel, Jammu** · Return to hotel | 6 km |
| 19:50 – 20:15 | HALT | **Hotel, Jammu** · Freshen up; Day 2 briefing (ID proofs, light bag for Bhawan, 06:30 breakfast) | |
| 20:15 – 21:15 | DINNER | **Hotel restaurant, Jammu** · Dinner – at the hotel, pre-ordered pure-veg menu; group pays (not in room rate) | |

Saturday 13 March 2027 · Timings are indicative and may change with flight slots, weather and darshan queues. Distances by road are approximate.


Sanjichhat Helipad


Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Bhawan

**DAY 02**
Sun 14 Mar

# Katra – Helicopter to Vaishno Devi Bhawan

Overnight: **Bhawan**

Drive to Katra at the foot of the Trikuta mountain, collect your RFID Yatra card and board the helicopter to Sanjichhat. A 2.5 km walk, pony or battery-car ride brings you to Bhawan. After rest and kirtan, enter the Holy Cave for darshan of the three Pindis and attend the Evening Aarti.

### SACRED SIGNIFICANCE

In the Holy Cave the Mother is worshipped in the form of three natural rock Pindis, representing Maha Kali, Maha Lakshmi and Maha Saraswati. The shrine sits at about 5,200 ft on the Trikuta mountain.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 06:30 – 07:00 | BREAKFAST | **Hotel restaurant, Jammu** · Breakfast – complimentary with the hotel stay (request 06:30 opening) | |
| 07:00 – 07:15 | HALT | **Hotel, Jammu** · Check-out, load luggage | |
| 07:15 – 08:45 | CAR | **Hotel, Jammu → Katra** · Drive via Jammu–Katra highway (NH144 / Nagrota); 10-min tea stop en route | 50 km |
| 08:45 – 09:15 | REGISTRATION | **Yatra Registration Counter, Katra** · Collect RFID Yatra cards for every yatri (carry original photo ID) | |
| 09:15 – 09:25 | CAR | **Katra town → Katra Helipad** · Drive to helipad; main luggage stays in car / Katra hotel | 2 km |
| 09:25 – 10:30 | REPORTING | **Katra Helipad** · Report per allotted slot (typically 1–2 hrs before), ticket & ID check, baggage weighing, security | |
| 10:30 – 10:40 | HELICOPTER | **Katra Helipad → Sanjichhat Helipad** · Flight approx. 5–8 min (about 5 km aerial) | |
| 10:40 – 11:45 | WALK / PONY / BATTERY CAR | **Sanjichhat Helipad → Bhawan** · 2.5 km track to Bhawan (walk ~45–60 min; battery car or pony quicker) | |
| 11:45 – 12:15 | HALT | **Bhawan** · Check-in at Bhawan accommodation, deposit belongings in cloak room | |
| 12:15 – 13:00 | LUNCH | **Shrine Board Bhojanalaya, Bhawan** · Lunch – Shrine Board (SMVDSB) Bhojanalaya; pure-veg, pay at counter | |
| 13:00 – 16:30 | REST | **Bhawan** · Rest, japa, group kirtan | |
| 16:30 – 18:00 | DARSHAN | **Holy Cave, Bhawan** · Queue for darshan of the three Pindis (Mahakali, Mahalakshmi, Mahasaraswati) | |
| 18:00 – 19:30 | AARTI | **Bhawan** · Evening Aarti (Atka Aarti passes to be booked in advance) | |
| 19:30 – 20:30 | DINNER | **Shrine Board Bhojanalaya, Bhawan** · Dinner – Shrine Board (SMVDSB) Bhojanalaya; pay at counter; rest after | |

Sunday 14 March 2027 · Timings are indicative and may change with flight slots, weather and darshan queues. Distances by road are approximate.


Ropeway to Bhairon Ghati


Banganga, Katra

**DAY 03**
Mon 15 Mar

# Morning Aarti – Bhairon Temple – Katra

Overnight: **Katra**

Rise early for the Morning Aarti, then take the ropeway to Bhairon Baba Temple. Walk down to Sanjichhat for the return flight to Katra. After rest, visit Banganga and Darshani Deodi, the traditional gateway of the yatra, and end the day at Katra's market.

### SACRED SIGNIFICANCE

Tradition holds that the yatra is complete only after darshan at Bhairon Baba Temple. At Banganga, the Mother is believed to have shot an arrow into the earth to bring forth water.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 04:30 – 05:30 | HALT | **Bhawan** · Wake-up, bath, get ready | |
| 05:30 – 07:00 | AARTI | **Bhawan** · Morning Aarti at the Holy Cave | |
| 07:00 – 07:30 | BREAKFAST | **Shrine Board Bhojanalaya, Bhawan** · Breakfast – Shrine Board Bhojanalaya; pay at counter (Bhawan rooms do not include meals) | |
| 07:30 – 07:45 | HALT | **Bhawan** · Check-out, collect cloak-room items | |
| 07:45 – 08:00 | WALK | **Bhawan → Bhawan ropeway station** · Short walk (~300 m) to lower ropeway station | |
| 08:00 – 08:20 | ROPEWAY | **Bhawan ropeway station → Bhairon Ghati** · Ropeway ride ~3 min plus queue (optional; trek 1.5 km otherwise) | |
| 08:20 – 09:00 | DARSHAN | **Bhairon Baba Temple** · Darshan of Bhairon Baba – completes the yatra | |
| 09:00 – 10:00 | WALK / PONY | **Bhairon Temple → Sanjichhat Helipad** · Downhill track ~3 km via Bhairon–Sanjichhat route | |
| 10:00 – 11:00 | REPORTING | **Sanjichhat Helipad** · Report for return slot, ticket & baggage check | |
| 11:00 – 11:10 | HELICOPTER | **Sanjichhat Helipad → Katra Helipad** · Return flight approx. 5–8 min | |
| 11:10 – 11:25 | CAR | **Katra Helipad → Hotel, Katra** · Pick-up at helipad, drive to hotel | 2 km |
| 11:25 – 12:15 | HALT | **Hotel, Katra** · Check-in, freshen up | |
| 12:15 – 13:00 | LUNCH | **Hotel restaurant / pure-veg restaurant, Katra** · Lunch – at the Katra hotel or a pure-veg restaurant on Main Bazaar; group pays | |
| 13:00 – 16:00 | REST | **Hotel, Katra** · Rest | |
| 16:00 – 16:15 | CAR | **Hotel, Katra → Banganga** · Drive to Banganga | 3 km |
| 16:15 – 17:00 | DARSHAN | **Banganga** · Holy river where Mata shot an arrow to bring water; sprinkle / dip, temple darshan | |
| 17:00 – 17:10 | CAR | **Banganga → Darshani Deodi** · Short hop | 1 km |
| 17:10 – 17:40 | DARSHAN | **Darshani Deodi** · Traditional gateway of the yatra; group photo | |
| 17:40 – 17:55 | CAR | **Darshani Deodi → Katra Main Bazaar** · Drive to market | 2 km |
| 17:55 – 19:30 | SHOPPING | **Katra Main Bazaar** · Prasad, chunri, dry fruits, walnut & handicraft shopping | |
| 19:30 – 19:45 | CAR / WALK | **Katra Main Bazaar → Hotel, Katra** · Return to hotel, freshen up | 1 km |
| 20:00 – 21:00 | DINNER | **Hotel restaurant, Katra** · Dinner – at the hotel, pre-ordered pure-veg menu; group pays; Day 4 briefing | |

Monday 15 March 2027 · Timings are indicative and may change with flight slots, weather and darshan queues. Distances by road are approximate.


Dal Lake, Srinagar


Katra welcome gate

**DAY 04**
Tue 16 Mar

# Katra – Flight to Srinagar – Dal Lake

Overnight: **Srinagar**

After breakfast, drive from Katra to Jammu Airport and fly to Srinagar. After lunch and rest at your hotel or houseboat, glide across Dal Lake on a shikara with kirtan as the sun sets behind the hills.

**DID YOU KNOW?**

Dal Lake's shikaras and houseboats have welcomed pilgrims and travellers to Srinagar for generations; the lake is fed by springs and mountain streams of the Zabarwan range.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 07:00 – 07:45 | BREAKFAST | **Hotel restaurant, Katra** · Breakfast – complimentary with the hotel stay | |
| 07:45 – 08:00 | HALT | **Hotel, Katra** · Check-out, load luggage | |
| 08:00 – 09:30 | CAR | **Hotel, Katra → Jammu Airport** · Drive to Jammu Airport | 50 km |
| 09:30 – 11:00 | AIRPORT | **Jammu Airport** · Check-in, security (carry ID; power banks in cabin bag) | |
| 11:00 – 11:50 | FLIGHT | **Jammu Airport → Srinagar Airport** · Flight Jammu → Srinagar, about 50 min (time to match booked flight) | |
| 11:50 – 12:15 | AIRPORT | **Srinagar Airport** · Baggage collection, meet Srinagar driver | |
| 12:15 – 13:00 | CAR | **Srinagar Airport → Hotel / houseboat, Dal Lake** · Drive to Boulevard Road | 14 km |
| 13:00 – 14:00 | LUNCH | **Hotel / houseboat restaurant, Srinagar** · Lunch – at the hotel / houseboat after check-in; group pays | |
| 14:00 – 16:45 | REST | **Hotel / houseboat, Dal Lake** · Rest after the early start | |
| 16:45 – 17:00 | WALK | **Hotel → Shikara ghat, Dal Lake** · Walk to nearest shikara ghat | |
| 17:00 – 18:30 | SHIKARA | **Dal Lake** · Sunset shikara ride past Char Chinari and Nehru Park; kirtan on the boat (floating market runs only at dawn) | |
| 18:30 – 20:00 | REST | **Hotel / houseboat, Dal Lake** · Rest; Day 5 briefing (warm clothes, overnight bag for Gulmarg) | |
| 20:00 – 21:00 | DINNER | **Hotel / houseboat restaurant, Srinagar** · Dinner – hotel on MAP plan (breakfast + dinner included) | |

Tuesday 16 March 2027 · Timings are indicative and may change with flight slots, weather and darshan queues. Distances by road are approximate.


Maharani Temple, Gulmarg


Gulmarg Gondola

**DAY 05**
Wed 17 Mar

# Gulmarg – Gondola & Maharani Temple

Overnight: **Gulmarg**

It is Amalaki Ekadashi: we fast from grains together and honour the day with kirtan. Drive to Gulmarg, the Meadow of Flowers, ride the gondola towards Apharwat for snow views, then take darshan at the hilltop Maharani Shiva temple and watch the sunset over the meadow.

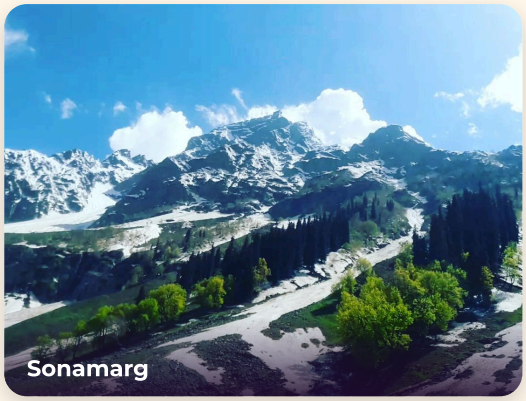
**DID YOU KNOW?**

The Gulmarg Gondola is among the highest cable cars in the world; its second phase climbs to about 4,000 m on Apharwat.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 07:00 – 07:45 | BREAKFAST | **Hotel restaurant, Srinagar** · Breakfast – included (MAP); Amalaki Ekadashi – grain-free items; check-out | |
| 07:45 – 09:30 | CAR | **Hotel, Srinagar → Gulmarg** · Drive via Tangmarg (hire snow boots / coats at Tangmarg in winter) | 50 km |
| 09:30 – 13:00 | GONDOLA | **Gulmarg Gondola: Kongdori (Phase 1) and Apharwat (Phase 2)** · Gondola ride (optional; book tickets online in advance); Snow Point and Apharwat Peak views | |
| 13:00 – 14:00 | LUNCH | **Pure-veg restaurant, Gulmarg** · Lunch – Amalaki Ekadashi: grain-free Ekadashi prasadam (fruits, potato, sabudana), pre-ordered; group pays | |
| 14:00 – 14:30 | HALT | **Hotel, Gulmarg** · Check-in | |
| 14:30 – 15:00 | REST | **Hotel, Gulmarg** · Short rest | |
| 15:00 – 15:15 | CAR | **Hotel, Gulmarg → Maharani Temple** · Short drive / walk across the meadow | 2 km |
| 15:15 – 16:00 | DARSHAN | **Maharani Temple (Shiva temple), Gulmarg** · Darshan at the hilltop Shiva temple in the Gulmarg meadow | |
| 16:00 – 17:30 | SIGHTSEEING | **Gulmarg meadow viewpoints** · Meadow walk, Himalayan views at sunset, group photo | |
| 17:30 – 20:00 | REST | **Hotel, Gulmarg** · Rest, kirtan; Day 6 briefing (early start, long drive) | |
| 20:00 – 21:00 | DINNER | **Hotel restaurant, Gulmarg** · Dinner – included (MAP); Ekadashi grain-free menu pre-ordered with the hotel | |

Wednesday 17 March 2027 · Timings are indicative and may change with flight slots, weather and darshan queues. Distances by road are approximate.


Kheer Bhawani, Tulmulla


Sonamarg

**DAY 06**
Thu 18 Mar

# Kheer Bhawani – Sonamarg – Srinagar

Overnight: **Srinagar**

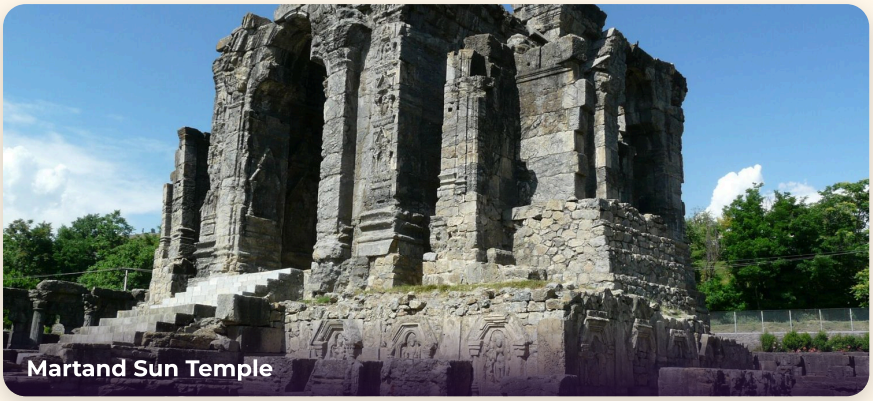
Break the Ekadashi fast after 7:14 am, then drive to Kheer Bhawani in Tulmulla for darshan of Mata Ragnya Devi. Continue along the Sindh river to Sonamarg, the Meadow of Gold, for Thajiwas Glacier and the snow, and return to Srinagar in the evening.

### SACRED SIGNIFICANCE

At Kheer Bhawani the Mother is worshipped as Ragnya Devi in a sacred spring; devotees offer kheer, and the spring's changing colour is regarded as a sign by the faithful.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 07:15 – 07:45 | BREAKFAST | **Hotel restaurant, Gulmarg** · Break fast (parana) 07:14–10:26 – breakfast from 07:15, included (MAP); check-out ready before | |
| 07:45 – 09:30 | CAR | **Gulmarg → Kheer Bhawani Temple, Tulmulla** · Drive via Tangmarg and Ganderbal | 70 km |
| 09:30 – 10:15 | DARSHAN | **Kheer Bhawani Temple** · Darshan of Mata Ragnya Devi at the sacred spring; kheer offering | |
| 10:15 – 12:15 | CAR | **Tulmulla → Sonamarg** · Scenic drive along the Sindh river | 60 km |
| 12:15 – 14:00 | PONY / LOCAL TAXI | **Sonamarg → Thajiwas Glacier** · Thajiwas Glacier by pony (optional, ~3 km; fixed union rates); snow play | |
| 14:00 – 14:45 | LUNCH | **Pure-veg restaurant, Sonamarg** · Lunch – pure-veg dhaba / restaurant at Sonamarg market; group pays | |
| 14:45 – 15:30 | SIGHTSEEING | **Sindh River viewpoints, Sonamarg** · Sindh river banks and snow-peak viewpoints; group photo | |
| 15:30 – 18:30 | CAR | **Sonamarg → Hotel, Srinagar** · Return to Srinagar | 82 km |
| 18:30 – 20:00 | REST | **Hotel, Srinagar** · Check-in, rest, kirtan | |
| 20:00 – 21:00 | DINNER | **Hotel restaurant, Srinagar** · Dinner – included (MAP) | |

Thursday 18 March 2027 · Timings are indicative and may change with flight slots, weather and darshan queues. Distances by road are approximate.


Martand Sun Temple


Betaab Valley

**DAY 07**
Fri 19 Mar

# Avantipur – Martand – Pahalgam

Overnight: **Pahalgam**

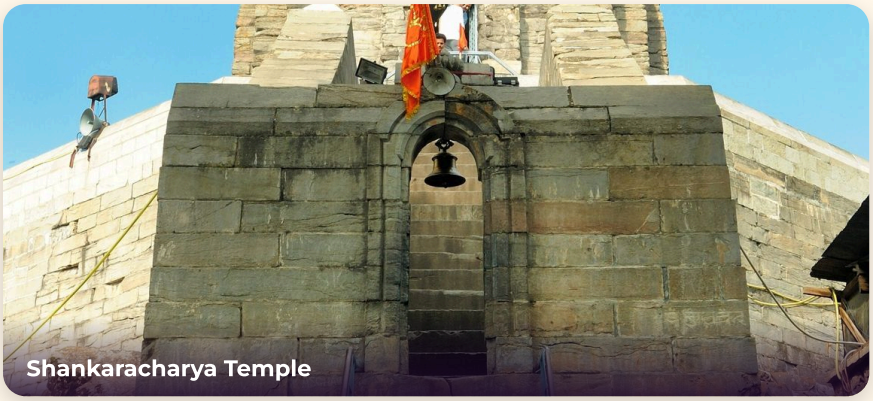
On the way to Pahalgam visit the 9th-century Avantipur temple ruins and the 8th-century Martand Sun Temple. In the afternoon, local cabs take you towards Chandanwari, Betaab Valley and Aru Valley, ending with an evening walk by the Lidder river.

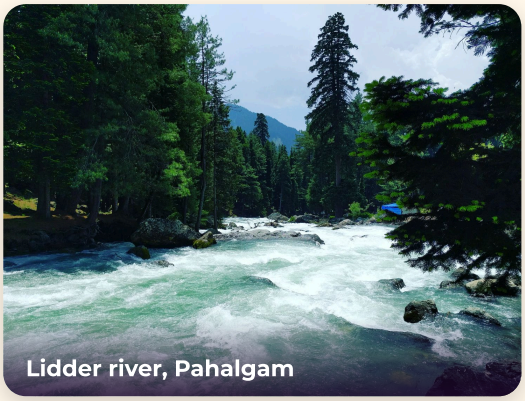
**DID YOU KNOW?**

The Martand Sun Temple was built by King Lalitaditya Muktapida in the 8th century and is one of the finest examples of Kashmiri temple architecture.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 07:00 – 07:45 | BREAKFAST | **Hotel restaurant, Srinagar** · Breakfast – included (MAP); check-out | |
| 07:45 – 08:45 | CAR | **Hotel, Srinagar → Avantipur Temple Ruins** · Drive on the Jammu–Srinagar highway | 30 km |
| 08:45 – 09:30 | SIGHTSEEING | **Avantipur Temple Ruins** · 9th-century Avantiswami (Vishnu) temple ruins | |
| 09:30 – 10:30 | CAR | **Avantipur → Martand Sun Temple** · Via Anantnag | 35 km |
| 10:30 – 11:15 | SIGHTSEEING | **Martand Sun Temple** · 8th-century Surya temple ruins on the Mattan plateau | |
| 11:15 – 12:30 | CAR | **Martand → Hotel, Pahalgam** · Drive along the Lidder river | 40 km |
| 12:30 – 13:00 | HALT | **Hotel, Pahalgam** · Check-in | |
| 13:00 – 14:00 | LUNCH | **Hotel restaurant, Pahalgam** · Lunch – at the Pahalgam hotel; group pays | |
| 14:00 – 14:15 | HALT | **Pahalgam taxi stand** · Board local union cabs (our car cannot go beyond Pahalgam) | |
| 14:15 – 14:55 | UNION CAB | **Pahalgam → Chandanwari** · 16 km by union cab | |
| 14:55 – 15:30 | SIGHTSEEING | **Chandanwari** · Start point of the Amarnath route; snow bridge (season) | |
| 15:30 – 15:50 | UNION CAB | **Chandanwari → Betaab Valley** · 7 km | |
| 15:50 – 16:30 | SIGHTSEEING | **Betaab Valley** · Meadows and river, photo stop (entry ticket) | |
| 16:30 – 17:20 | UNION CAB | **Betaab Valley → Aru Valley** · 21 km via Pahalgam | |
| 17:20 – 18:00 | SIGHTSEEING | **Aru Valley** · Meadow village, pine forests | |
| 18:00 – 18:30 | UNION CAB | **Aru Valley → Hotel, Pahalgam** · 12 km back to Pahalgam | |
| 18:30 – 19:30 | WALK | **Lidder River banks** · Evening walk by the Lidder river; kirtan | |
| 20:00 – 21:00 | DINNER | **Hotel restaurant, Pahalgam** · Dinner – included (MAP) | |

Friday 19 March 2027 · Timings are indicative and may change with flight slots, weather and darshan queues. Distances by road are approximate.


Shankaracharya Temple


Lidder river, Pahalgam

**DAY 08**
Sat 20 Mar

# Shankaracharya – Jyeshta Devi – Departure

Departure · **Jai Mata Di!**

Return to Srinagar for darshan at the hilltop Shankaracharya Temple and Jyeshta Devi Temple. After lunch and shopping for saffron, dry fruits and pashmina, transfer to Srinagar Airport with the blessings of Mata Vaishno Devi and Lord Shiva.

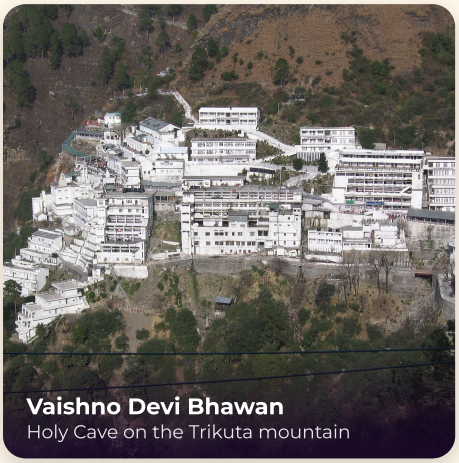
### SACRED SIGNIFICANCE

Shankaracharya Temple, dedicated to Lord Shiva, stands on a hill about 1,000 ft above Srinagar with sweeping views of Dal Lake.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 07:00 – 07:45 | BREAKFAST | **Hotel restaurant, Pahalgam** · Breakfast – included (MAP); check-out | |
| 07:45 – 10:30 | CAR | **Pahalgam → Shankaracharya Temple, Srinagar** · Drive to Srinagar | 95 km |
| 10:30 – 11:45 | DARSHAN | **Shankaracharya Temple** · Hilltop Shiva temple, ~240 steps from the parking; views of Dal Lake (phones not allowed – leave in car) | |
| 11:45 – 12:00 | CAR | **Shankaracharya Temple → Jyeshta Devi Temple** · Drive to Zethyar | 6 km |
| 12:00 – 12:40 | DARSHAN | **Jyeshta Devi Temple** · Darshan of Mata Jyeshta Devi | |
| 12:45 – 13:45 | LUNCH | **Pure-veg restaurant, Srinagar** · Lunch – pure-veg restaurant near Lal Chowk / Durganag; group pays | |
| 13:45 – 14:45 | SHOPPING | **Lal Chowk / Polo View Market, Srinagar** · Saffron, dry fruits, walnut wood, pashmina (buy from government emporium for authenticity) | |
| 14:45 – 15:30 | CAR | **Lal Chowk → Srinagar Airport** · Drive to airport (allow for security checkpoints) | 14 km |
| 15:30 – 16:00 | DEPARTURE | **Srinagar Airport** · Drop-off, farewell, Jai Mata Di! Har Har Mahadev! (flights after 17:30; reach 2.5 hrs early) | |

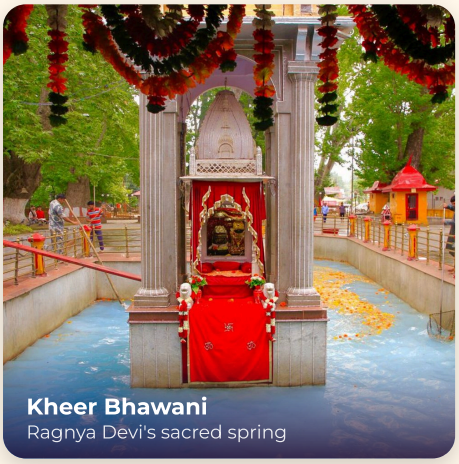
Saturday 20 March 2027 · Timings are indicative and may change with flight slots, weather and darshan queues. Distances by road are approximate.

# Sacred places *on this yatra*


**Vaishno Devi Bhawan**
Holy Cave on the Trikuta mountain


**Sanjichhat Helipad**
Helicopter landing near Bhawan

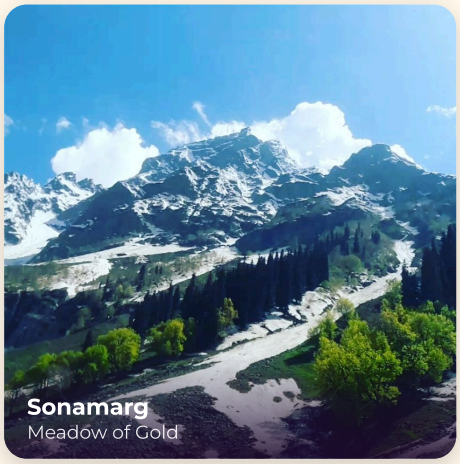

**Bahu Fort, Jammu**
Home of Bawe Wali Mata


**Kheer Bhawani**
Ragnya Devi's sacred spring


**Shankaracharya Temple**
Hilltop Shiva temple, Srinagar


**Martand Sun Temple**
8th-century Surya temple


**Maharani Temple, Gulmarg**
Shiva temple in the meadow


**Sonamarg**
Meadow of Gold


**Dal Lake**
Shikara at sunset

## PACKAGE INCLUDES

- Accommodation: Jammu (1 night), Bhawan (1 night), Katra (1 night) with breakfast; Srinagar hotel / houseboat (2 nights), Gulmarg (1 night), Pahalgam (1 night) with breakfast & dinner
- Helicopter tickets Katra ⇄ Sanjichhat and Bhairon ropeway
- Flight Jammu → Srinagar
- All transfers and sightseeing by private vehicle (about 641 km)
- Union cabs at Pahalgam; Dal Lake shikara ride
- Pure-vegetarian meals as per the meal plan, including Ekadashi prasadam
- Atka Aarti passes (subject to Shrine Board availability); monument entry tickets
- Tour leader and escort; daily kirtan and sthala purana
- Travel insurance

## NOT INCLUDED

- Air or train fare to Jammu and from Srinagar (can be arranged)
- Day 1 breakfast (on own while travelling)
- Gulmarg gondola tickets (optional, booked on request)
- Pony at Sonamarg; pony / palki at Vaishno Devi (paid on actuals)
- Personal offerings, shopping, tips and porterage
- GST as applicable

PACKAGE PRICE & DATES

### Saturday 13 – Saturday 20 March 2027

Price on request · limited seats (helicopter quota).
Call **95053 88886** for the latest price and seats.

## MEAL PLAN · PURE VEGETARIAN

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Day 1 | BREAKFAST | 08:00–08:30 | On own – at home / origin airport / in flight |
| Day 1 | LUNCH | 15:15–15:50 | Hotel restaurant, Jammu |
| Day 1 | DINNER | 20:15–21:15 | Hotel restaurant, Jammu |
| Day 2 | BREAKFAST | 06:30–07:00 | Hotel restaurant, Jammu |
| Day 2 | LUNCH | 12:15–13:00 | Shrine Board Bhojanalaya, Bhawan |
| Day 2 | DINNER | 19:30–20:30 | Shrine Board Bhojanalaya, Bhawan |
| Day 3 | BREAKFAST | 07:00–07:30 | Shrine Board Bhojanalaya, Bhawan |
| Day 3 | LUNCH | 12:15–13:00 | Hotel restaurant / pure-veg restaurant, Katra |
| Day 3 | DINNER | 20:00–21:00 | Hotel restaurant, Katra |
| Day 4 | BREAKFAST | 07:00–07:45 | Hotel restaurant, Katra |
| Day 4 | LUNCH | 13:00–14:00 | Hotel / houseboat restaurant, Srinagar |
| Day 4 | DINNER | 20:00–21:00 | Hotel / houseboat restaurant, Srinagar |
| Day 5 | BREAKFAST | 07:00–07:45 | Hotel restaurant, Srinagar |
| Day 5 | LUNCH | 13:00–14:00 | Pure-veg restaurant, Gulmarg |
| Day 5 | DINNER | 20:00–21:00 | Hotel restaurant, Gulmarg |
| Day 6 | BREAKFAST | 07:15–07:45 | Hotel restaurant, Gulmarg |
| Day 6 | LUNCH | 14:00–14:45 | Pure-veg restaurant, Sonamarg |
| Day 6 | DINNER | 20:00–21:00 | Hotel restaurant, Srinagar |
| Day 7 | BREAKFAST | 07:00–07:45 | Hotel restaurant, Srinagar |
| Day 7 | LUNCH | 13:00–14:00 | Hotel restaurant, Pahalgam |
| Day 7 | DINNER | 20:00–21:00 | Hotel restaurant, Pahalgam |
| Day 8 | BREAKFAST | 07:00–07:45 | Hotel restaurant, Pahalgam |
| Day 8 | LUNCH | 12:45–13:45 | Pure-veg restaurant, Srinagar |

# How we are *different*

**1 Sattvic food**
Pure-vegetarian meals planned for every day; no onion-garlic on request

**2 Pre-approved stays**
Hotels checked and approved by Punya Kshetras, not booked blind

**3 Comfortable transport**
Clean, well-kept vehicles with experienced hill drivers

**4 Care for seniors**
Escorts on the track, pony / palki arranged in advance, unhurried pace

**5 Narration by devotees**
Sthala purana and the glories of each holy place, in Telugu, Hindi and English

**6 Family-like yatra**
Kirtan, japa and satsang every day with ISKCON Hare Krishna devotees

**7 No hidden charges**
No service or booking charges; one clear package price

## CURATED SPECIAL EXPERIENCES

- Melodious bhajans & kirtans
- Sthala purana narrations
- Comfortable stay
- Relaxed itinerary
- Special care for seniors
- Sattvic food


Moments from our past yatras


Devotees on yatra with Punya Kshetras

## PACK THESE

- Original photo ID + copy
- Thermals, warm jacket, cap, gloves
- Small day bag for Bhawan
- Walking shoes with grip
- Sunglasses for snow glare
- Personal medicines
- Postpaid SIM, power bank

## DO'S

- Carry original photo ID at all times
- Keep the RFID Yatra card with you from Katra
- Report 10 minutes before every departure
- Stay with your buddy; wear the group scarf
- Use cloak rooms before darshan
- Dress in warm layers in Kashmir

## DON'TS

- No phones, cameras or leather goods in darshan areas
- No extra baggage on the helicopter
- Don't rely on prepaid SIMs from outside J&K
- Don't buy prasad from touts
- Don't wear new shoes
- Don't photograph security forces

## FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

### Who can join?

Anyone in reasonable health. Seniors are welcome; we pre-arrange pony, palki or battery car for those who cannot walk the 2.5 km track.

### What ID do I need?

Original Aadhaar or passport for every yatri, including for the RFID Yatra card at Katra and for flights.

### Will my phone work?

Prepaid SIMs from outside Jammu & Kashmir do not work there. Carry a postpaid connection; our team carries postpaid phones.

### What food is served?

Pure-vegetarian meals throughout; no onion-garlic food on request at hotels.

### Is Kashmir safe for pilgrims?

We travel with a registered local partner and follow daily advisories from the hotel and authorities; the plan is adjusted if any area is closed.

### How cold will it be in March?

Days are cool and nights near or below freezing in Gulmarg, Sonamarg and Pahalgam. Pack thermals, a warm jacket, cap and gloves; snow boots can be hired at Tangmarg.

## BOOKING & PAYMENT

Seats are confirmed only after the advance is received. Full and final payment is due before departure; yatris cannot join the tour otherwise. We accept bank transfer, UPI, cheque and cash; card payments carry 2% extra.

## CANCELLATION BY YATRI

Requests must be sent in writing to connect@hkmhyderabad.org. More than 45 days before travel: 30% of tour cost retained, 70% refunded. 45 to 30 days: 50% retained. Less than 30 days, no-show, or after the tour starts: no refund. Refunds are paid after 30 days of cancellation.

## RESCHEDULING

Allowed once, subject to availability, on payment of 10% of the tour cost, if requested at least 7 days before travel. Later requests are treated as a cancellation.

## HELICOPTER & WEATHER

Helicopter services to Sanjichhat are run under Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Shrine Board rules and depend on weather. If a flight is cancelled or delayed, our team will arrange the best alternative (next slot, pony, palki or the track). Extra stay, food or transport caused by weather, technical reasons or government orders is borne by the yatris.

## BAGGAGE

Only a small hand bag is allowed on the helicopter; the main luggage waits in the vehicle or hotel. Yatris must declare their correct weight at booking.

## MEDICAL

Please tell us about any medical condition or special need at the time of booking. Consult your doctor before the yatra. Punya Kshetras is not liable for medical emergencies; evacuation costs are borne by the yatri.

## GOVERNMENT LEVIES

Any increase in taxes, temple or government charges after booking is payable by the yatris before departure.

## CONDUCT

We may cancel the participation of any yatri who is unruly, intoxicated or unsafe to travel, without refund.

## CANCELLATION BY US

If we cancel the yatra, the amount paid is refunded in full; no compensation is payable for consequential loss.

## DISPUTES

Subject to the jurisdiction of courts in Hyderabad, Telangana. Booking implies acceptance of these terms.

## WHO JOINED OUR YATRAS



HARE KRISHNA GOLDEN TEMPLE
BANJARA HILLS

PUNYA KSHETRAS
NOURISH YOUR SOUL ON SACRED JOURNEYS

*Pilgrimage is reconnection with God*

**For details & registration**

Please contact any temple devotee you are in touch with, or

# 95053 88886

✉ booking@punyakshetras.com

www.punyakshetras.com · www.hkmhyderabad.org

Facebook · Instagram · YouTube · X: @punyakshetras · HareKrishnaGoldenTemple

Swayambhu Sri Lakshmi Narasimha Swamy Kshetram, Road #12, near Anti Corruption Bureau office, NBT Nagar, Banjara Hills, Hyderabad, Telangana 500034

*Jai Mata Di! Har Har Mahadev!*

Photo credits (Wikimedia Commons, used under their licences): Ancient Temple, Gulmarg – Anurag Kumar, CC BY-SA 4.0; Aruvillage – KennyOMG, CC BY-SA 4.0; Avantipura ruins – Ajitparthan, CC BY-SA 3.0; Bahu Fort, Jammu – Vedant Sharma, CC BY-SA 4.0; Banganga (Shri Mata Vaishno Devi) – Thenipunanand, CC BY-SA 4.0; Betaab Valley – Nandanupadhyay, CC BY-SA 3.0; DBSQN5qUQAAD zY – Shivansh.ganjoo, CC BY-SA 4.0; Dal Lake Hazratbal Srinagar – Suhail Skindar Sofi, CC BY-SA 4.0; Gulmarg gondola – Arup1981, CC BY-SA 4.0; Houses and Shops located in Katra, Jammu and Kashmir – Anubhav Sinha, CC BY-SA 2.0; LiddarRiverJhelum – Unknown, CC0; Martand Sun Temple Central shrine (6133772365) – Varun Shiv Kapur from New Delhi, India, CC BY 2.0; Pawan Hans VT-PHA taking off – KuwarOnline Talk, CC BY 3.0; Sanji Chhat helipad vaishno devi – Mabhishek84, CC BY-SA 3.0; Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Bhawan, Katra Jammu & Kashmir INDIA – KDhruv406, CC BY 4.0; Sonmarg rishav7336 – Wikiditot, CC BY-SA 4.0; The Ancient Shankaracharya Temple (Srinagar, Jammu and Kashmir) (cropped) – Divya Gupta, CC BY-SA 3.0; The Temples of Raghunath, Jammu, India, ca.1875-ca.1940 (imp-cswc-GB-237-CSWC47-LS10-011) – Unknown author, Public domain; Trikuta Mountains – KuShahrukh Tendulkar, CC BY-SA 4.0; Vaishno Devi Bhavan – Abhishek Chandra, Public domain; Vaishno Devi Bhawan – Raulcaeser, CC BY-SA 3.0; Vaishno Devi entrance – Thenerdatul, CC BY 4.0; Vaishno devi – Raju hardoi, CC BY-SA 3.0. Srila Prabhupada photographs and past-yatra photos © Hare Krishna Golden Temple / respective owners.